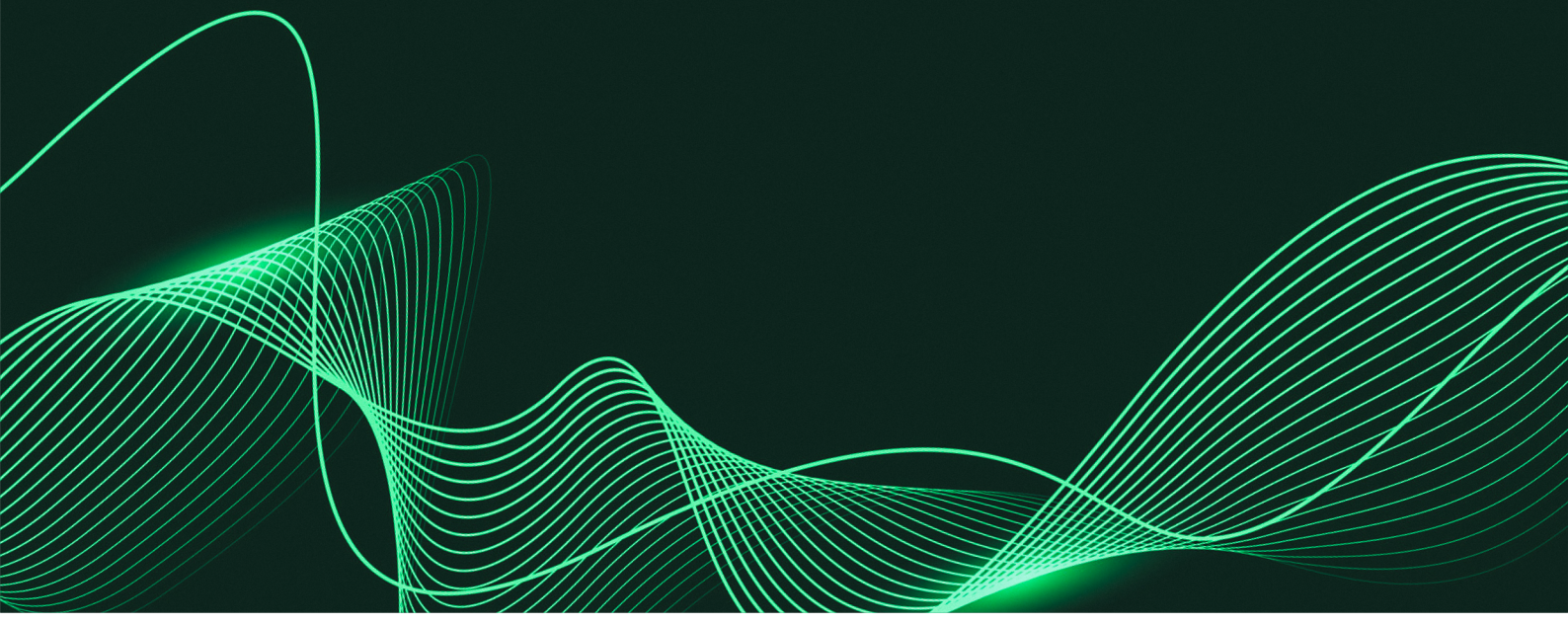
BANK OF INDUSTRY
...transforming Nigeria's industrial sector

ESG CONFERENCE

Building Resilient and Responsible Enterprises: ESG as a Strategic Imperative for Nigerian SMEs

Tuesday, October 28, 2025
In-Person
Federal Palace Hotel
Victoria Island, Lagos

Official Event Brochure



ORGANISER
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FOREWORD



DR. OLASUPO OLUSI
Managing Director / Chief Executive Officer
Bank of Industry

The ESG Conference was conceived as a platform to unpack the challenges hampering ESG adoption among small and medium-sized enterprises, present case studies of successful implementation, and offer practical solutions to catalyse uptake at a time when sustainability is moving from the periphery to the core of business strategy.

SMEs are essential drivers of economic growth, innovation, and employment. Yet, despite their potential to move the needle on Nigeria's sustainability agenda, many face persistent barriers to adopting environmental, social, and governance practices.

Recognising that the sustainability journey of Nigeria's SMEs determines the nation's broader transition to a resilient economy, the Bank of Industry has a critical role to play.

For sixty-five years, the Bank has been facilitating SME growth through lending, business advisory, concessionary loans, extended repayment terms, and sector-specific interventions.

Supporting their ESG journey is therefore a natural progression of our mission. Through the integration of sustainability principles into business strategy, SMEs can strengthen their resilience, competitiveness, and long-term value creation.

This Conference reflects our commitment to working closely with diverse stakeholders - government, investors, development partners, and the private sector to help Nigerian enterprises navigate their ESG journey and thrive in a dynamic global environment.

We are determined to build an ecosystem where responsible business values and decarbonisation become the norm.

Together, we can ensure that ESG serves not only as a compliance agenda, but as a catalyst for innovation, competitiveness, and inclusive prosperity across Nigeria's enterprise landscape.

EVENT HIGHLIGHTS

12	200+	20+	1
Speakers	Companies	Ecosystem Enablers	Groundbreaking Research Launch

VISION

> To establish a leading forum for cross-sector collaboration, knowledge exchange, and transparent reporting on the advancement of ESG practices among Nigerian enterprises.

OUR MISSION

To catalyze the transformation of Nigerian enterprises toward a climate-resilient, responsible and sustainable economy.

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

In recent years, Nigerian companies have shown growing interest in the business sustainability agenda.

However, much of the attention has focused on the efforts of large and listed corporations to embed environmental, social and governance (ESG) principles in their operations.

In reality, achieving national progress in this space requires active participation from small and medium-sized enterprises (SMEs) - the engine of Nigeria's economic growth.

Although many SMEs already contribute meaningfully to social and environmental well-being, the unique challenges they face in adopting ESG practices have not received the attention they deserve.

The ESG Conference therefore seeks to:

- Diagnose the challenges Nigerian SMEs encounter in adopting ESG principles
- Proffer practical solutions and tailored support mechanisms
- Open access channels to credit facilities, incentives and partnerships that promote sustainable business transformation..

SPEAKERS



ACHENYO IDACHABA-OBARO
Founder/CEO
Mitimeth



ADESUWA OKUNBO RHODES
Founder / CEO
Aruwa Capital Management



BANKE KUKU
Creative Director / Founder, Banke Kuku



BERNADETTE EJIOFOR
Green Climate Fund Desk Officer
National Council Climate Change (NCCC)



DR. OLASUPO OLUSI
MD/CEO, Bank of Industry



DR. OLU OGUNFOWORA
Managing Director
Ideanest



MAHAMADOU DIARRA
Deputy Country Director, Agence Française de Développement (AFD) Nigeria



NAOMI NWOKOLO, ESQ.
CEO, UN Global Compact Network Nigeria



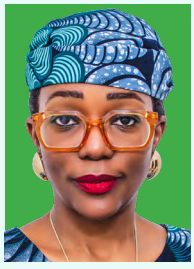
OLUYEMISI IRANLOYE
Founder/CEO
Psaltry International Company Limited



ROTIMI AKINDE
Executive Director
Corporate Finance Sustainability & Investments
Bank of Industry



SHEKARAU OMAR
Executive Director
Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises
Bank of Industry



TENIOYE MAJEKODUNMI
Director General
National Council Climate Change (NCCC)



INTRODUCTION

As Nigeria continues to advance its sustainability journey, the conference theme -"**Building Resilient and Responsible Enterprises: ESG as a Strategic Imperative for Nigerian SMEs**"- underscores the urgent need to embed Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) principles into business strategy and operations.

The event will convene leading experts, practitioners, and ecosystem enablers to explore practical pathways for SMEs to integrate ESG frameworks into their growth models.

Through evidence-based discussions and real-world case studies, speakers will demonstrate the business value of ESG adoption-showcasing how responsible practices can drive competitiveness, resilience, and long-term value creation across Nigeria's enterprise landscape.

WHY ESG MATTERS

Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) standards provide a framework for measuring a business's non-financial performance, including its impacts, risks, and opportunities. In today's global economy, financial indicators alone no longer determine business value.

Growing evidence shows that strong ESG performance enhances environmental stewardship, reduces operational risks, strengthens social capital, and deepens community trust.

It also opens doors to new sources of finance and creates long-term value for customers, investors, and stakeholders.

As a scorecard, ESG now informs investment decisions, leadership evaluations, resilience assessments, brand positioning, progress toward the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), and credit risk analysis-making it central to business competitiveness and sustainable growth.



A COMPELLING CASE FOR UNBLOCKING SMES ESG ADOPTION BOTTLENECKS

Until now, Nigerian SMEs have lacked a high-profile national platform dedicated to addressing the unique challenges they face in adopting Environmental, Social, and Governance (ESG) practices. The ESG Conference fills that gap.

By adopting a bottom-up approach centred on SMEs, the Bank of Industry (BOI) is demonstrating its commitment to empowering small and medium enterprises - the backbone of Nigeria's economy - with the knowledge, tools, and financial support required to drive ESG adoption.

BOI's decades-long experience serving SMEs provides deep insight into both the financial and non-financial constraints they face in embedding sustainability practices.

This SME-focused approach complements the Bank's broader ESG engagements with Nigeria's large corporates, ensuring a holistic and inclusive national transition toward responsible business.

SMES AT THE HEART OF SUSTAINABILITY

According to the National Bureau of Statistics (NBS), MSMEs collectively account for 48% of Nigeria's GDP, represent 96% of all registered businesses, employ 84% of the workforce, and contribute 6.21% of export trade.

Their scale and reach make SMEs pivotal to Nigeria's sustainability transition - from reducing carbon emissions and managing waste, to preserving biodiversity and unlocking the nation's green growth potential.

Indeed, the active participation of SMEs in ESG adoption is essential to achieving Nigeria's Energy Transition Plan (ETP) and meeting its Nationally Determined Contribution (NDC) targets under the Paris Agreement.

By embedding ESG principles, SMEs can become key drivers of inclusive, climate-smart, and resilient growth across Nigeria's economy.

OBJECTIVES OF THE CONFERENCE

- Raise awareness on ESG as a strategic business imperative
- Empower SMEs with actionable tools and frameworks to operationalise ESG
- Foster partnerships between policymakers, investors, DFIs, and MSMEs
- Share success stories and case studies of SMEs leading ESG integration
- Public presentation of **ESG Adoption by Nigerian MSMEs Report**

KEY TAKEAWAYS

The ESG for SMEs conference is not just about dialogue.

The conference organisers are committed to helping SMEs to access the tools, financing, and partnerships necessary to build enterprises that are resilient, profitable, and sustainable for the future.

Key conference takeaways will include how SMEs can

- Embed sustainability into business models as a driver of growth and resilience.
- Measure and report ESG progress using practical, SME-friendly metrics.
- Fuse ESG considerations as part of decision-making for capital acquisitions
- Imbibe lessons from relatable case studies of SMEs that have successfully integrated ESG principles
- Unpack government policies and regulations on decarbonisation and the circular economy.

WHY ATTEND

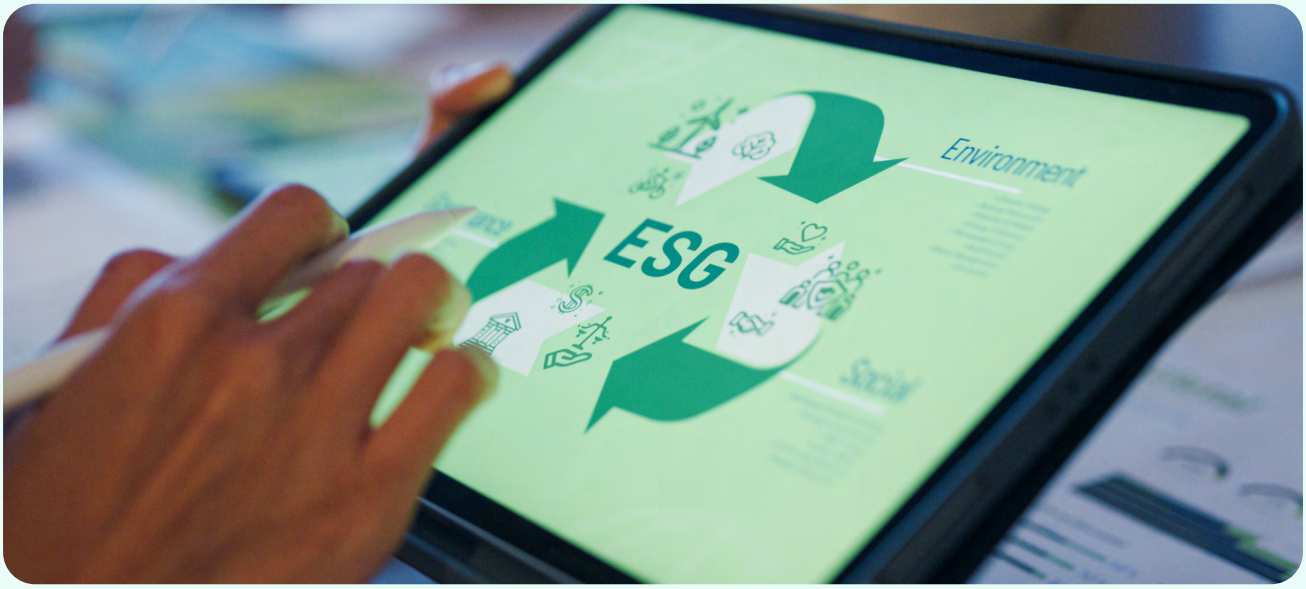
- Listen to the most impactful ways of incorporating ESG principles and sustainability thinking into your business practices
- Network with other attendees to facilitate the sharing of ideas and experiences
- Gain awareness of the importance of sustainability and ESG
- Discover how the Bank of Industry is supporting SMEs to adopt ESG practices through targeted credit products and tailored advisory services
- Get inspiration to be part of the vanguard of companies implementing sustainable practices and taking action on responsible business commitments
- Hear practical case studies with realistic steps from actual companies that have implemented ESG principles
- Learn about federal government initiatives and intervention funds for accelerating ESG adoption in Nigeria
- Find out about funding, partnership, and training opportunities from BOI, development partners, and non-governmental ecosystem enablers for fast-tracking ESG adoption.

BOI'S ROLE & COMMITMENT

The Bank of Industry plays a pioneering role in enabling Nigeria's sustainable economic growth by

- Providing sustainable financing products for SMEs and corporates
- Offering advisory services and technical assistance
- Driving strategic partnerships with local and international ecosystem enablers to drive ESG adoption at scale





AGENDA

Time	Activity
8:30 – 10:00 a.m.	Arrival of Guests and Registration
10:00 – 10:05 a.m.	National Anthem
10:05 – 10:15 a.m.	Welcome Address by **Dr. Olasupo Olusi**, MD/CEO, Bank of Industry
10:15 – 10:25 a.m.	Goodwill messages • **Naomi Nwaokolo, Esq.**, CEO UN Global Compact Network Nigeria • **Mahamadou Diarra**, Deputy Country Director, Agence Française De Développement (AFD) Nigeria
10:25 – 10:40 a.m.	Keynote Address by **Tenioye Majekodunmi**, Director-General, National Council on Climate Change (NCCC)
10:40 – 11:40 a.m.	**Panel Session** **Thriving in a Changing World: ESG pathways for Nigerian SMEs** **Panelists** • **Yemisi Iranloye**, MD/CEO, Psaltry International • **Shekarau Omar**, Executive Director, Micro, Small and Medium-sized Enterprises, Bank of Industry • **Adesuwa Okunbo-Rhodes**, Founding Partner/CEO, Aruwa Capital Management • **Bernadette Ejiofor**, Green Climate Fund Desk Officer, National Council on Climate Change (NCCC) • **Dr. Olu Ogunfowora**, MD, Ideanest Investments • **Banke Kuku**, Founder/Creative Director, Banke Kuku Moderator - **Lehlé Baldé**
11:40 – 11:50 a.m.	**ESG in Action – A Fireside Chat** **A fireside conversation** between **Achenyo Idachaba-Obaro**, Founder/ Creative Director, and **Rotimi Akinde**, Executive Director, Corporate Finance, Sustainability & Investments, Bank of Industry
11:50 – 12:00 p.m.	**Summary of the "ESG Adoption by Nigerian MSMEs Report"** by **Rotimi Akinde**, ED, Corporate Finance, Sustainability & Investments
12:00 – 12:10 p.m.	**Launch of the "ESG Adoption by Nigerian MSMEs" Report**
12:10 – 12:15 p.m	Pictures
12:15 – 12:20 p.m.	Event recap and vote of thanks by **Eniola Akinsete**, Chief Sustainability Officer, Bank of Industry and **Obiora Onyeaso**, CEO, Bienfair
12:30 p.m.	Lunch

TARGET AUDIENCE

- Corporate senior management
- Sustainability Experts
- Sustainability/ESG Teams
- Safety, Health & Environment Managers and Officers,
- Functional/ Departmental Heads Heads (HR, PR, Marketing, Operations, Finance, Risk and Compliance Managers, etc.)
- Government officials, Regulators and Policymakers
- Nonprofits
- Professional associations
- Industry groups
- Academia and Think Tanks
- Development Finance Institutions
- International organizations and donors
- Lenders
- Private equity firms
- Venture capital firms

Panel Moderator



LEHLÉ BALDÉ

Master of Ceremonies



JONATHAN HANSON

Conference Directors



ENIOLA AKINSETE
Chief Sustainability Officer,
Bank of Industry



OBIORA TABANSI ONYEASO
Managing Director,
Bienfair

ABOUT THE ORGANISERS

BANK OF INDUSTRY
...transforming Nigeria's industrial sector

The Bank of Industry (BOI) is Nigeria's leading development finance institution, dedicated to fostering industrialisation, economic growth, and sustainable development.

BOI supports businesses across an array of sectors, including manufacturing, agriculture, technology, and renewable energy, with a focus on empowering micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs).

As part of its commitment to addressing climate change, BOI actively promotes Nigeria's transition to a low-carbon economy by funding renewable energy, energy efficiency, and climate-resilient projects. Through concessionary financing, technical support, and ESG-focused operations, BOI aims to drive inclusive growth and create a sustainable future.

BOI continues to execute its mandate to empower Nigerian businesses to adopt environmentally sustainable and socially inclusive practices, contributing to a resilient and prosperous economy.

https://boi.ng/

Bienfair
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Bienfair is a critical issues and stakeholder economy consultancy.

The company's work mainly focuses on establishing its clients as agents of positive change, and assisting them in embedding ESG principles within their organisations.

https://bienfair.com/



NOTES

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ESG CONFERENCE

For further information, contact
esgconference@boi.ng
www.esgbyboinigeria.com

